

# Outpatient Rehabilitation (Physical Therapy, Occupational Therapy)



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## Medicare Advantage Medical Coverage Policy

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#### Disclaimer

The Medical Coverage Policies are reviewed by all Utilization Management Committees within Humana. Policies in this document may be modified by a member's coverage document. Clinical policy is not intended to preempt the judgment of the reviewing medical director or dictate to health care providers how to practice medicine. Health care providers are expected to exercise their medical judgment in rendering appropriate care. Identification of selected brand names of devices, tests and procedures in a medical coverage policy is for reference only and is not an endorsement of any one device, test, or procedure over another. Clinical technology is constantly evolving, and we reserve the right to review and update this policy periodically. References to CPT® codes or other sources are for definitional purposes only and do not imply any right to reimbursement or guarantee of claims payment. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise, without permission from Humana and subsidiaries.

## Related Medicare Advantage Medical/Pharmacy Coverage Policies

[Functional Electrical Stimulators \(Non-Pain\)](#)  
[Headache and Occipital Neuralgia Treatments](#)  
[Injections for Chronic Pain Conditions](#)  
[Peripheral Nerve Stimulators](#)

## Related CMS Documents

Please refer to [CMS Medicare Coverage Database](#) for the most current applicable CMS National Coverage Determination (NCD)/Local Coverage Determination (LCD)/Local Coverage Article (LCA). Refer to CMS website for the most current applicable [CMS Online Manual System \(IOMs\)](#) and [Transmittals](#).

Humana and subsidiaries apply a Medicare Administrative Contractor's (MAC's) LCD to all requests (both Part A and Part B services) within the MAC's applicable geographic jurisdiction.

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| Type                               | Title                                                      | Document ID Number                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Jurisdiction<br>Medicare<br>Administrative<br>Contractors<br>(MACs) | Applicable<br>States/Territories |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Internet-Only<br>Manuals<br>(IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit<br>Policy Manual, Chapter 12 | §40 –<br>Comprehensive<br>Outpatient<br>Rehabilitation<br>Facility (CORF)<br>Coverage                                                                                                                                |                                                                     |                                  |
| Internet-Only<br>Manuals<br>(IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit<br>Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §220 –<br>Coverage of<br>Outpatient<br>Rehabilitation<br>Therapy<br>Services<br>(Physical<br>Therapy,<br>Occupational<br>Therapy, and<br>Speech-<br>Language<br>Pathology<br>Services)<br>Under Medical<br>Insurance |                                                                     |                                  |
| Internet-Only<br>Manuals<br>(IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit<br>Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §220.1 –<br>Conditions<br>of Coverage<br>and<br>Payment for<br>Outpatient<br>Physical<br>Therapy,<br>Occupational<br>Therapy, or<br>Speech-<br>Language<br>Pathology<br>Services                                     |                                                                     |                                  |
| Internet-Only                      |                                                            | §220.1.2 –<br>Plans of Care<br>for                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                     |                                  |

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|                              |                                                         |                                                                                          |  |  |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| Manuals (IOMs)               | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | Outpatient Physical Therapy, Occupational Therapy, or Speech-Language Pathology Services |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §220.2 – Reasonable and Necessary Outpatient Rehabilitation Therapy Services             |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §220.3 – Documentation Requirements for Therapy Services                                 |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §230 – Practice of Physical Therapy, Occupational Therapy, and Speech-Language Pathology |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §230.1 – Practice of Physical Therapy                                                    |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §230.2 – Practice of Occupational Therapy                                                |  |  |
| Internet-Only Manuals (IOMs) | Pub. 100-02, Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15 | §230.5 – Physical Therapy, Occupational Therapy and Speech-Language Pathology            |  |  |

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|            |                                                                                         | Services Provided Incident to the Services of Physicians and Non-Physician Practitioners (NPP) |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| NCD        | Acupuncture for Chronic Lower Back Pain (cLBP)                                          | 30.3.3                                                                                         |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| NCD        | Diathermy Treatment                                                                     | 150.5                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| NCD        | Electrical Stimulation (ES) and Electromagnetic Therapy for the Treatment of Wounds     | 270.1                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| NCD        | Fluidized Therapy Dry Heat for Certain Musculoskeletal Disorders                        | 150.8                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| NCD        | Heat Treatment, Including the Use of Diathermy and Ultra-Sound for Pulmonary Conditions | 240.3                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| NCD        | Infrared Therapy Devices                                                                | 270.6                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                            |
| LCD<br>LCA | Outpatient Physical and Occupational Therapy Services                                   | L33631<br>A56566                                                                               | J6 - National Government Services, Inc. (Part A/B MAC)<br><br>JK - National Government Services, Inc. (Part A/B MAC) | IL, MN, WI<br><br>CT, MA, ME, NH, NY, RI, VT               |
| LCD<br>LCA | Outpatient Physical and Occupational Therapy Services                                   | L34049<br>A57067                                                                               | J15 - CGS Administrators, LLC (Part A/B MAC)                                                                         | KY, OH                                                     |
| LCA        | Billing and Coding: Medical Necessity of Therapy Services                               | A53304                                                                                         | JE - Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC                                                                              | CA, HI, NV, American Samoa, Guam, Northern Mariana Islands |
| LCA        | Billing and Coding: Medical Necessity of Therapy Services                               | A52775                                                                                         | JF - Noridian Healthcare Solutions, LLC                                                                              | AK, AZ, ID, MT, ND, OR, SD, UT, WA, WY                     |
| LCD<br>LCA | Outpatient Occupational Therapy                                                         | L34427<br>A53064                                                                               | JJ - Palmetto GBA (Part A/B MAC)                                                                                     | AL, GA, TN                                                 |

|  |                             |                  |                                        |                |
|--|-----------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|
|  | Outpatient Physical Therapy | L34428<br>A53065 | JM - Palmetto<br>GBA (Part A/B<br>MAC) | NC, SC, VA, WV |
|--|-----------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|

## Description

### [§1861 of the Social Security Act](#)

**Physical therapy (PT)** is the treatment of disorders or injuries using physical methods or modalities. A PT modality is often defined as any physical agent applied to produce therapeutic changes to biologic tissues. Modalities that are commonly used include exercises, thermal, cold, ultrasonic or electric energy devices. Therapeutic modalities are passive in nature and are generally used to enable an individual to take part in active aspects of therapy.

PT may be indicated for the treatment of muscle weakness, limitations in range of motion, neuromuscular conditions, musculoskeletal conditions and/or lymphedema. PT may also be indicated for select training of an individual in specific techniques and exercises for independent use at home.

Therapeutic procedures are intended as a method of affecting change using clinical skills, techniques and/or services with the goal of functional improvement. PT procedures generally include therapeutic exercises and joint mobilization, and have been shown to be an effective treatment for numerous musculoskeletal conditions.

Medically necessary PT services must be restorative in nature or for specific purposes of designing and teaching a maintenance program for an individual to carry out at home. The services must also relate to a complex, written treatment plan requiring the judgment, knowledge and skills of a physical therapist (or medical doctor/doctor of osteopathy) to perform and/or directly supervise. The amount, frequency and duration of PT services must be seen as medically appropriate for the specific treatment regimen and be performed by a physical therapist.

A qualified physical therapist, for benefit coverage purposes, is an individual who is licensed as a physical therapist by the state in which he or she is practicing. A physical therapist assistant (PTA) is an individual who is licensed as a PTA, if applicable, by the state in which he or she is practicing. The services of a PTA must be supervised by a licensed physical therapist at a level of supervision determined by state law or regulation.

**Occupational therapy (OT)** is a form of rehabilitation therapy involving the treatment of various dysfunctions (including neuromuscular) through the use of specific tasks or goal-directed activities to improve an individual's functional performance. Therapy programs are designed to improve quality of life in the recovery of specific competencies, maximizing independence and the prevention of specific illness or disability.

OT includes helping an individual learn or relearn specific daily living skills (eg, basic activities of daily living [ADL]) such as dressing, eating, personal hygiene, self-care and mobility/transfers. OT also includes specific

task oriented therapeutic activities designed to restore physical function of the shoulder, elbow, wrist and/or hand that has been lost because of illness or injury. Occupational therapy can include the design, fabrication, fitting and maintenance of orthotics and related self-help devices including the fitting and fabrication of splints for the upper extremity.

Medically necessary OT services must relate to a complex, written treatment plan requiring the judgment, knowledge and skills of an occupational therapist (or medical doctor/doctor of osteopathy) to perform and/or directly supervise these services. The amount, frequency and duration of occupational therapy services must be medically appropriate for the specific treatment regimen and be performed by an occupational therapist.

A qualified occupational therapist, for benefit coverage purposes, is an individual who is licensed as an occupational therapist by the state in which he or she is practicing. An occupational therapy assistant (OTA) is an individual who is licensed as an OTA, if applicable, by the state in which he or she is practicing. The services of an OTA must be supervised by a licensed occupational therapist at a level of supervision determined by state law or regulation.

#### **Low Level Laser Therapy**

Low level laser therapy (LLLT) refers to a wide variety of noninvasive treatments, including, but not limited to, cold laser and photobiomodulation. LLLT uses red beam or near infrared nonthermal lasers to attempt to promote healing and reduce pain in variety of conditions, such as alopecia, rheumatoid disorders, arthritis, carpal tunnel syndrome, chronic pain, prevention of oral mucositis, temporomandibular joint disorders, tissue injuries (eg, tendinopathy, tendinitis), and various other musculoskeletal pathology disorders. Upon application, the laser light penetrates the surface of the skin and purportedly induces healing through a biostimulatory effect after absorption of the light. These devices are not the same as (or equivalent to) class IV *surgical* lasers.

#### **High Power Laser Therapy**

High power laser therapy, also known as high intensity laser therapy (HILT) or deep tissue laser therapy, intends to promote accelerated healing in deeper tissues (ligaments, muscles) by stimulating blood flow. HILT is purportedly used to treat osteoarthritis, carpal tunnel syndrome, chronic pain and various other musculoskeletal pathology disorders. HILT uses class IV therapeutic lasers for increased penetration, resulting from a long wavelength and high energy output, to induce therapeutic cellular metabolic changes. These devices are not the same as (or equivalent to) class IV *surgical* lasers.

For information regarding coverage determination/limitations not addressed in this medical coverage policy, please refer to the following:

| Service                                                                       | Corresponding Medicare Medical Coverage Policy               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Neuromuscular, functional and diaphragmatic/phrenic nerve stimulation therapy | <a href="#">Functional Electrical Stimulators (Non-Pain)</a> |
| Treatments for headache and/or occipital neuralgia                            | <a href="#">Headache and Occipital Neuralgia Treatments</a>  |

|                                                                                 |                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Nerve blocks, trigger point injections and injections for chronic pain          | <a href="#">Injections for Chronic Pain Conditions</a> |
| Peripheral nerve stimulators, electrical stimulators and/or stimulation therapy | <a href="#">Peripheral Nerve Stimulators</a>           |

## Coverage Determination

*Humana and subsidiaries follow the Medicare requirements that only allow coverage and payment for services that are reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis and treatment of illness or injury or to improve the functioning of a malformed body member except as specifically allowed by Medicare.*

*Humana and subsidiaries apply any applicable National Coverage Determination (NCD) and any applicable Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) to the services and jurisdiction at issue. See the Related CMS Documents Section above for any such NCDs or LCDs.*

Please refer to the following CMS sources for guidance regarding **outpatient rehabilitation therapy (physical therapy, occupational therapy)**:

- Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 12
- Medicare Benefit Policy Manual, Chapter 15

For Jurisdictions without an LCD, Humana and subsidiaries determine medical necessity for **outpatient occupational therapy** based on the criteria contained in:

- LCD – Outpatient Occupational Therapy (L34427)

For Jurisdictions without an LCD, Humana and subsidiaries determine medical necessity for **outpatient physical therapy** based on the criteria contained in:

- LCD – Outpatient Physical Therapy (L34428)

*The use of the criteria above provides clinical benefits highly likely to outweigh any clinical harms (eg, continued pain, falls, no improvement in flexibility, mobility and strength, and worsening of conditions<sup>65,87</sup>). Services that do not meet the criteria above are not medically necessary and may result in unnecessary exposure to potential complications. Medically unnecessary services carry risks of adverse outcomes and may interfere with the pursuit of other treatments which have demonstrated efficacy.*

*In interpreting or supplementing the criteria above and in order to determine medical necessity consistently for visits per episode, Humana and subsidiaries may consider [MCG Guidelines](#).*

## Coverage Limitations

[US Government Publishing Office. Electronic code of federal regulations: part 411 – 42 CFR § 411.15 - Particular services excluded from coverage](#)

The literature and scientific evidence supporting the use of **peripheral nerve blocks with or without the use of electrostimulation, and the use of electrostimulation alone for neuropathies or peripheral neuropathies caused by underlying systemic diseases** is insufficient to warrant coverage. These procedures are considered investigational and are not eligible for coverage for the treatment of neuropathies or peripheral neuropathies caused by underlying systemic diseases.<sup>26,27,28,29,30,35,36</sup> Use of physical medicine and rehabilitation CPT/HCPCS codes (97032, 97139, G0282, G0283) for treatment of neuropathies or peripheral neuropathies caused by underlying systemic diseases is inappropriate.<sup>21,22,23,24,25</sup>

For jurisdictions without fully established guidance because CMS is silent (**J5, J8, JE, JF, JH, JL, JJ, JN**), **low level laser therapy** (O552T, 97037) will **not** be considered medically reasonable and necessary.

A review of the current medical literature shows that the **evidence is insufficient** to determine that this service is standard medical treatment. There is an absence of current, widely-used treatment guidelines or acceptable clinical literature (as defined by CMS) examining benefit and long-term clinical outcomes establishing the value of this service in clinical management.

**High power laser therapy** (97039) will **not** be considered medically reasonable and necessary.

A review of the current medical literature shows that the **evidence is insufficient** to determine that this service is standard medical treatment. There is an absence of current, widely-used treatment guidelines or acceptable clinical literature (as defined by CMS) examining benefit and long-term clinical outcomes establishing the value of this service in clinical management.

## Summary of Evidence

### **Low Level Laser Therapy**

While there is a moderate amount of data available regarding LLLT, the studies are severely limited by trial outline and deviations in protocol, resulting in inconclusive results. The literature is mixed regarding the effectiveness of LLLT, consequently requiring additional research for consistent evidence of clinical efficacy.<sup>47,86,89</sup>

### **High Power Laser Therapy**

An independent technology assessment organization<sup>52</sup> concludes that the safety and effectiveness of high power laser therapy is uncertain. While some data has shown improved function after the use of high power laser therapy, the studies have a high risk of bias and evaluate a limited number of patients, therefore there is an overall low quality body of evidence suggesting the use of high power laser therapy. Additional research is necessary to validate the clinical efficacy of high power laser therapy.<sup>51,52,60</sup>



## Coding Information

Any codes listed on this policy are for informational purposes only. Do not rely on the accuracy and inclusion of specific codes. Inclusion of a code does not guarantee coverage and/or reimbursement for a service or procedure.

| CPT® Code(s) | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Comments |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 20999        | Unlisted procedure, musculoskeletal system, general                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |          |
| 29200        | Strapping; thorax                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |          |
| 29240        | Strapping; shoulder (eg, Velpeau)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |          |
| 29260        | Strapping; elbow or wrist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |          |
| 29280        | Strapping; hand or finger                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |          |
| 29520        | Strapping; hip                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |          |
| 29530        | Strapping; knee                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |          |
| 29540        | Strapping; ankle and/or foot                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |          |
| 29550        | Strapping; toes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |          |
| 29799        | Unlisted procedure, casting or strapping                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |          |
| 96000        | Comprehensive computer-based motion analysis by video-taping and 3D kinematics;                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |          |
| 96001        | Comprehensive computer-based motion analysis by video-taping and 3D kinematics; with dynamic plantar pressure measurements during walking                                                                                                                                                                              |          |
| 96004        | Review and interpretation by physician or other qualified health care professional of comprehensive computer-based motion analysis, dynamic plantar pressure measurements, dynamic surface electromyography during walking or other functional activities, and dynamic fine wire electromyography, with written report |          |
| 97010        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; hot or cold packs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |          |
| 97012        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; traction, mechanical                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |          |
| 97014        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; electrical stimulation (unattended)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |          |
| 97016        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; vasopneumatic devices                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |          |
| 97018        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; paraffin bath                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |          |
| 97022        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; whirlpool                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |          |
| 97024        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; diathermy (eg, microwave)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |          |
| 97026        | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; infrared                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |          |

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 97028 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; ultraviolet                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| 97032 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; electrical stimulation (manual), each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| 97033 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; iontophoresis, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| 97034 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; contrast baths, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| 97035 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; ultrasound, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| 97036 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; Hubbard tank, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| 97037 | Application of a modality to 1 or more areas; low-level laser therapy (ie, nonthermal and non-ablative) for post-operative pain reduction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| 97039 | Unlisted modality (specify type and time if constant attendance)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| 97110 | Therapeutic procedure, 1 or more areas, each 15 minutes; therapeutic exercises to develop strength and endurance, range of motion and flexibility                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| 97112 | Therapeutic procedure, 1 or more areas, each 15 minutes; neuromuscular reeducation of movement, balance, coordination, kinesthetic sense, posture, and/or proprioception for sitting and/or standing activities                                                                                                                                                               |  |
| 97113 | Therapeutic procedure, 1 or more areas, each 15 minutes; aquatic therapy with therapeutic exercises                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| 97116 | Therapeutic procedure, 1 or more areas, each 15 minutes; gait training (includes stair climbing)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| 97124 | Therapeutic procedure, 1 or more areas, each 15 minutes; massage, including effleurage, petrissage and/or tapotement (stroking, compression, percussion)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
| 97129 | Therapeutic interventions that focus on cognitive function (eg, attention, memory, reasoning, executive function, problem solving, and/or pragmatic functioning) and compensatory strategies to manage the performance of an activity (eg, managing time or schedules, initiating, organizing, and sequencing tasks), direct (one-on-one) patient contact; initial 15 minutes |  |

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 97130 | Therapeutic interventions that focus on cognitive function (eg, attention, memory, reasoning, executive function, problem solving, and/or pragmatic functioning) and compensatory strategies to manage the performance of an activity (eg, managing time or schedules, initiating, organizing, and sequencing tasks), direct (one-on-one) patient contact; each additional 15 minutes (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| 97139 | Unlisted therapeutic procedure (specify)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| 97140 | Manual therapy techniques (eg, mobilization/ manipulation, manual lymphatic drainage, manual traction), 1 or more regions, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| 97150 | Therapeutic procedure(s), group (2 or more individuals)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| 97161 | Physical therapy evaluation: low complexity, requiring these components: A history with no personal factors and/or comorbidities that impact the plan of care; An examination of body system(s) using standardized tests and measures addressing 1-2 elements from any of the following: body structures and functions, activity limitations, and/or participation restrictions; A clinical presentation with stable and/or uncomplicated characteristics; and Clinical decision making of low complexity using standardized patient assessment instrument and/or measurable assessment of functional outcome. Typically, 20 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family.                                        |  |
| 97162 | Physical therapy evaluation: moderate complexity, requiring these components: A history of present problem with 1-2 personal factors and/or comorbidities that impact the plan of care; An examination of body systems using standardized tests and measures in addressing a total of 3 or more elements from any of the following: body structures and functions, activity limitations, and/or participation restrictions; An evolving clinical presentation with changing characteristics; and Clinical decision making of moderate complexity using standardized patient assessment instrument and/or measurable assessment of functional outcome. Typically, 30 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family. |  |

|       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 97163 | Physical therapy evaluation: high complexity, requiring these components: A history of present problem with 3 or more personal factors and/or comorbidities that impact the plan of care; An examination of body systems using standardized tests and measures addressing a total of 4 or more elements from any of the following: body structures and functions, activity limitations, and/or participation restrictions; A clinical presentation with unstable and unpredictable characteristics; and Clinical decision making of high complexity using standardized patient assessment instrument and/or measurable assessment of functional outcome. Typically, 45 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |
| 97164 | Re-evaluation of physical therapy established plan of care, requiring these components: An examination including a review of history and use of standardized tests and measures is required; and Revised plan of care using a standardized patient assessment instrument and/or measurable assessment of functional outcome Typically, 20 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| 97165 | Occupational therapy evaluation, low complexity, requiring these components: An occupational profile and medical and therapy history, which includes a brief history including review of medical and/or therapy records relating to the presenting problem; An assessment(s) that identifies 1-3 performance deficits (ie, relating to physical, cognitive, or psychosocial skills) that result in activity limitations and/or participation restrictions; and Clinical decision making of low complexity, which includes an analysis of the occupational profile, analysis of data from problem-focused assessment(s), and consideration of a limited number of treatment options. Patient presents with no comorbidities that affect occupational performance. Modification of tasks or assistance (eg, physical or verbal) with assessment(s) is not necessary to enable completion of evaluation component. Typically, 30 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family. |  |

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|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 97166 | Occupational therapy evaluation, moderate complexity, requiring these components: An occupational profile and medical and therapy history, which includes an expanded review of medical and/or therapy records and additional review of physical, cognitive, or psychosocial history related to current functional performance; An assessment(s) that identifies 3-5 performance deficits (ie, relating to physical, cognitive, or psychosocial skills) that result in activity limitations and/or participation restrictions; and Clinical decision making of moderate analytic complexity, which includes an analysis of the occupational profile, analysis of data from detailed assessment(s), and consideration of several treatment options. Patient may present with comorbidities that affect occupational performance. Minimal to moderate modification of tasks or assistance (eg, physical or verbal) with assessment(s) is necessary to enable patient to complete evaluation component. Typically, 45 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family. |  |
| 97167 | Occupational therapy evaluation, high complexity, requiring these components: An occupational profile and medical and therapy history, which includes review of medical and/or therapy records and extensive additional review of physical, cognitive, or psychosocial history related to current functional performance; An assessment(s) that identifies 5 or more performance deficits (ie, relating to physical, cognitive, or psychosocial skills) that result in activity limitations and/or participation restrictions; and Clinical decision making of high analytic complexity, which includes an analysis of the patient profile, analysis of data from comprehensive assessment(s), and consideration of multiple treatment options. Patient presents with comorbidities that affect occupational performance. Significant modification of tasks or assistance (eg, physical or verbal) with assessment(s) is necessary to enable patient to complete evaluation component. Typically, 60 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family.               |  |
| 97168 | Re-evaluation of occupational therapy established plan of care, requiring these components: An assessment of changes in patient functional or medical status with revised plan of care; An update to the initial occupational profile to reflect changes in condition or environment that affect future interventions and/or goals; and A revised plan of care. A formal reevaluation is performed when there is a documented change in functional status or a significant change to the plan of care is required. Typically, 30 minutes are spent face-to-face with the patient and/or family.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |

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|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 97530 | Therapeutic activities, direct (one-on-one) patient contact (use of dynamic activities to improve functional performance), each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| 97533 | Sensory integrative techniques to enhance sensory processing and promote adaptive responses to environmental demands, direct (one-on-one) patient contact, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| 97535 | Self-care/home management training (eg, activities of daily living (ADL) and compensatory training, meal preparation, safety procedures, and instructions in use of assistive technology devices/adaptive equipment) direct one-on-one contact, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| 97537 | Community/work reintegration training (eg, shopping, transportation, money management, avocational activities and/or work environment/modification analysis, work task analysis, use of assistive technology device/adaptive equipment), direct one-on-one contact, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                          |  |
| 97542 | Wheelchair management (eg, assessment, fitting, training), each 15 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| 97545 | Work hardening/conditioning; initial 2 hours                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| 97546 | Work hardening/conditioning; each additional hour (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| 97550 | Caregiver training in strategies and techniques to facilitate the patient's functional performance in the home or community (eg, activities of daily living [ADLs], instrumental ADLs [iADLs], transfers, mobility, communication, swallowing, feeding, problem solving, safety practices) (without the patient present), face to face; initial 30 minutes                                                                   |  |
| 97551 | Caregiver training in strategies and techniques to facilitate the patient's functional performance in the home or community (eg, activities of daily living [ADLs], instrumental ADLs [iADLs], transfers, mobility, communication, swallowing, feeding, problem solving, safety practices) (without the patient present), face to face; each additional 15 minutes (List separately in addition to code for primary service) |  |
| 97552 | Group caregiver training in strategies and techniques to facilitate the patient's functional performance in the home or community (eg, activities of daily living [ADLs], instrumental ADLs [iADLs], transfers, mobility, communication, swallowing, feeding, problem solving, safety practices) (without the patient present), face to face with multiple sets of caregivers                                                |  |

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|                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                 |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 97750                                    | Physical performance test or measurement (eg, musculoskeletal, functional capacity), with written report, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                 |                 |
| 97755                                    | Assistive technology assessment (eg, to restore, augment or compensate for existing function, optimize functional tasks and/or maximize environmental accessibility), direct one-on-one contact, with written report, each 15 minutes     |                 |
| 97760                                    | Orthotic(s) management and training (including assessment and fitting when not otherwise reported), upper extremity(ies), lower extremity(ies) and/or trunk, initial orthotic(s) encounter, each 15 minutes                               |                 |
| 97761                                    | Prosthetic(s) training, upper and/or lower extremity(ies), initial prosthetic(s) encounter, each 15 minutes                                                                                                                               |                 |
| 97763                                    | Orthotic(s)/prosthetic(s) management and/or training, upper extremity(ies), lower extremity(ies), and/or trunk, subsequent orthotic(s)/prosthetic(s) encounter, each 15 minutes                                                           |                 |
| 97799                                    | Unlisted physical medicine/rehabilitation service or procedure                                                                                                                                                                            |                 |
| <b>CPT®<br/>Category III<br/>Code(s)</b> | <b>Description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Comments</b> |
| 0552T                                    | Low-level laser therapy, dynamic photonic and dynamic thermokinetic energies, provided by a physician or other qualified health care professional                                                                                         |                 |
| 0733T                                    | Remote body and limb kinematic measurement-based therapy ordered by a physician or other qualified health care professional; supply and technical support, per 30 days                                                                    |                 |
| 0734T                                    | Remote body and limb kinematic measurement-based therapy ordered by a physician or other qualified health care professional; treatment management services by a physician or other qualified health care professional, per calendar month |                 |
| 0791T                                    | Motor-cognitive, semi-immersive virtual reality–facilitated gait training, each 15 minutes (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                    |                 |
| <b>HCPCS<br/>Code(s)</b>                 | <b>Description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Comments</b> |
| G0129                                    | Occupational therapy services requiring the skills of a qualified occupational therapist, furnished as a component of a partial hospitalization treatment program, per session (45 minutes or more)                                       |                 |
| G0281                                    | Electrical stimulation, (unattended), to one or more areas, for chronic Stage III and Stage IV pressure ulcers, arterial ulcers, diabetic ulcers, and venous stasis ulcers not demonstrating                                              |                 |

|       |                                                                                                                                      |  |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|       | measurable signs of healing after 30 days of conventional care, as part of a therapy plan of care                                    |  |
| G0282 | Electrical stimulation, (unattended), to one or more areas, for wound care other than described in G0281                             |  |
| G0283 | Electrical stimulation (unattended), to one or more areas for indication(s) other than wound care, as part of a therapy plan of care |  |

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## Change Summary

01/01/2024 New Policy.  
 02/13/2024 Update, Coverage Change. Updated Coding Information  
 07/01/2024 Update, No Coverage Change.  
 10/08/2024 Annual Review, Coverage Change. Updated Coding Information  
 12/10/2024 Update, No Coverage Change.  
 01/03/2025 Provider Claims Codes Update, No Coverage Change.  
 02/12/2025 Provider Claims Codes Update, No Coverage Change.  
 05/01/2025 Provider Claims Codes Update, No Coverage Change  
 07/01/2025 Annual Review, Coverage Change. Updated Coding Information